MIL-L-18045F
8 August 1986
SUPERSEDING
MIL-L-18045E
27 September 1961
(See 6.6)

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

LIFE PRESERVERS, VEST, INHERENTLY BUOYANT

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers life preservers, vest, inherently buoyant which uses buoyant foam pads.

1.2 Classification. Life preservers shall be of the following types as specified (see 6.2.1):

Type I - Adult's (with collar).
Type II - Adult's (without collar).
Type III - Children's (with collar).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

V-F-106 - Fasteners, Slide, Interlocking.
V-T-276 - Thread, Cotton.
CCC-C-426 - Cloth, Drill, Cotton.
CCC-C-446 - Cloth, Muslin, Cotton.
DDD-T-86 - Tape, Textile, Cotton, General Purpose (Unbleached, Bleached, or Dyed).

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Commander, Naval Sea Systems Command, SEA 55Z3, Department of the Navy, Washington, DC 20362-5101 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 4220
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MIL-W-530 - Webbing, Textile, Cotton, General Purpose, Natural or in Colors.
MIL-L-3454 - Life Preservers, Packaging of.
MIL-P-15280 - Plastic Material, Unicellular (Sheets and Tubes).
MIL-G-16491 - Grommet, Metallic.

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-191 - Textile Test Methods.
FED-STD-595 - Colors.
FED-STD-751 - Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings.

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

2.1.2 Government drawings. The following Government drawings form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues shall be those in effect on the date of the solicitation.

DRAWINGS

BUREAU OF SHIPS

803-1419479 - Life Preserver, Vest, Inherently Buoyant: Assembly.
803-1419480 - Life Preserver, Vest, Inherently Buoyant: Patterns for Inside and Outside Jacket Section.
803-1419481 - Life Preserver, Vest, Inherently Buoyant: Pattern for Collar Section and Miscellaneous Details.
803-1419482 - Life Preserver, Vest, Inherently Buoyant: Patterns for Inserts.
803-1539167 - Life Preserver, Vest, Inherently Buoyant, Children's: Assembly.
803-1539168 - Life Preserver, Vest, Inherently Buoyant, Children's: Patterns for Inside and Outside Jacket Sections.
803-1539169 - Life Preserver, Vest, Inherently Buoyant, Children's: Pattern for Collar Section and Miscellaneous Details.
803-1539170 - Life Preserver, Vest, Inherently Buoyant, Children's: Patterns for Inserts.

(Copies of specifications, standards, and drawings required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein (except for associated detail specifications, specification sheets or MS standards), the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified in the contract or purchase order, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3 and 6.3).

3.2 Material.

3.2.1 Drill. Drill shall conform to type I, class 3 of CCC-C-426. The color shall conform to color number 36076 or 12246 of FED-STD-595 as specified (see 6.2.1). The drill conforming to color number 36076 shall be vat dyed and shall show good fastness to light, salt water, laundering, and crocking. The textile sea rescue colored drill shall be dyed with napthol colors and shall show good fastness to light, salt water, and laundering and shall show fair fastness to crocking.

3.2.2 Inherently buoyant foam. The inherently buoyant foam shall conform to MIL-P-15280.

3.2.3 Webbing. Webbing shall be 1-inch cotton webbing equal in color and color fastness to the cotton drill. It shall conform to type IIb of MIL-W-530 except that it may be dyed with napthol colors.

3.2.4 Tape.

3.2.4.1 Binding tape. The binding tape shall conform to DDD-T-86 and shall be equal in color and colorfastness to the cotton drill.

3.2.4.2 Tie loops and collar tie tapes. Tie loops and collar tie tapes shall be made from 3/4-inch cotton tape weighing not less than 0.18 ounce per linear yard and having a minimum breaking strength of 120 pounds. The color shall reasonably match that of the drill and shall show fair fastness to light, salt water, and crocking.

3.2.4.3 Jacket tie tapes and tunnel tapes. Jacket tie tapes and tunnel tapes shall be made from 1-1/8-inch cotton tape weighing not less than 0.27 ounce per linear yard and having a minimum breaking strength of 180 pounds. The color shall reasonably match that of the drill and shall show fair fastness to light, salt water, and crocking.

3.2.4.4 Reflective tape. Reflective tape shall be SOLAS grad stitch-on retro-reflective tape.

3.2.5 Metal hardware. The metal hardware shall be made from brass or corrosion resisting steel and shall have a dull black finish. Grommets shall conform to type I, class 3, size 00 of MIL-G-16491.

3.2.6 Slide fasteners. Slide fasteners shall be nylon on nylon tape, have enameled brass sliders, and conform to type I, style 2, size LM, of V-F-106, except that the tape width shall be 9/16 inch. The length of slide fasteners shall be 10 inches for types I and II life preservers and 8 inches for type III life preservers. Fasteners shall pass the salt spray test specified in V-F-106.

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The slider shall have a perforated enameled brass pull tab. The color of the tape and enamel shall acceptably match the color of the cotton drill specified (see 3.2.1). All metal components of the slide fastener shall be of the composition specified in V-F-106.

3.3 Design. The life preservers shall consist essentially of an outside and inside jacket, collar (except on type II), body strap, leg straps, and buoyant foam pads. The life preserver shall pass the visual and dimensional inspection of 4.5.

3.3.1 Outside and inside jacket. The outside and inside jacket shall be made from cotton drill (see 3.2.1).

3.3.2 Collar. The collar (types I and III only) shall be made from cotton drill (see 3.2.1).

3.3.3 Body straps and leg straps. Body straps and leg straps shall be made of 1-inch cotton webbing (see 3.2.3) in accordance with the applicable drawings shown in section 2. The body strap assembly shall have a minimum breaking strength of 360 pounds when tested in accordance with 4.6.2.

3.3.4 Inherently buoyant foam pads. There shall be four front pads (one upper and one lower pad on each side of the front) and one back pad. Types I and III life preservers shall also have one collar pad.

3.3.4.1 Distribution of buoyant medium. The buoyant foam pads shall be cut for types I and II in accordance with Drawing 803-1419482 and for type III in accordance with Drawing 803-1539170.

3.3.4.2 Buoyancy. The pads shall have the buoyancies specified in table I when tested as specified in 4.6.3.

TABLE I. Buoyancy.

	Type I and II	Type III
	Pounds	Pounds
Back pad	7.0 ± 0.5	3.25 ± 0.25
Upper front pad	4.0 ± 0.5	1.75 ± 0.25
Lower front pad	7.5 ± 0.5	3.25 ± 0.25

3.3.5 Tape. The tie-loops, tie tapes, and tunnel tape shall be of the width and length indicated on the applicable drawing (see 3.2.4).

3.3.6 Metal hardware. Grommets, strap tips, D-rings, adjustable tension slides, and snap hooks shall be in accordance with the applicable drawings (see 3.2.5).

3.3.7 Inspection tag. A tag of bleached print cloth type III, class 1 of CCC-C-446, 2-1/2 by 3-1/2 inches, shall be sewed on the bottom of the jacket on the inside of lining. The printing on the tag shall be in waterproof black ink, and shall be as shown on Drawing 803-1419479 or 803-1539167, as applicable.

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3.4 Construction.

3.4.1 The manufacture and assembly of type I and II life preservers shall conform to Drawings 803-1419479, 803-1419480, 803-1419481 and 803-1419482. The manufacture and assembly of type III life preservers shall conform to Drawings 803-1539167, 803-1539168, 803-1539169, and 803-1539170.

3.5 Stitching. All stitching shall be type 301 in accordance with FED-STD-751. Stitching of the cotton drill cover and collar shall be done with type IB3, number 20, 4-ply cotton thread equal in color to the cotton drill and conforming in physical characteristics and color fastness to V-T-276. Stitching in webbing and tapes and in webbing and tape attachments to drill shall be done with type IB3, number 16, 4-ply cotton thread equal in color to the cotton drill and conforming in physical characteristics and color fastness to V-T-276. Stitching of the reflective tape shall be done with type IB3, number 20, 4-ply cotton thread conforming to V-T-276. Reflective tape stitching shall be 8 to 12 stitches per inch around the outer perimeter of the tape, 3/32 $\pm$ 1/64 inch from corner to corner.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of defective material.

4.1.2 Test reports. Test reports shall be prepared in accordance with the data ordering document included in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2.2).

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

(a) First article inspection (see 4.3).
(b) Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

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4.3 First article inspection. First article inspection shall be performed on the submitted samples as specified in 3.1. First article inspection shall consist of the examination and tests of this specification (see 4.5 and 4.6).

4.3.1 Samples for first article inspection. Before starting regular production, the contractors shall submit the following samples for first article inspection:

(a) Two complete life preservers.
(b) Two square yards of each type fabric used.
(c) Four yards of each type of tape and webbing used.
(d) Two complete sets of buoyant pads.
(e) Two complete sets of all hardware used.
(f) One cone of each type of thread used.
(g) Six slide fasteners.

First article samples shall be forwarded to the Commander, David Taylor Naval Ship Research and Development Center, Attn: Code 2843, Annapolis, MD 21402. The samples shall be plainly identified by securely-attached durable tags marked with the following information:

(a) "Samples for first article tests."
(b) Name of product, together with complete identifying data, such as manufacturer's designation number.
(c) Name of manufacturer.
(d) Contract or order number.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection.

4.4.1 Quality conformance inspection. Quality conformance inspection shall be as specified in table II.

TABLE II. Quality conformance inspection.

Inspection	Requirement paragraph	Test paragraph
Group A		
Dimensions	3.3	4.5
Visual	3.3	4.5
Group B		
Breaking strength of body straps	3.3.4.1	4.6.2
Buoyancy	3.3.4.2	4.6.3

4.4.2 Sampling for lot acceptance.

4.4.2.1 Inspection lot. An inspection lot shall consist of not more than 3,000 life preservers of one type complete with body strap assemblies produced under essentially the same conditions and offered for inspection at one time.

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4.4.3 Sampling for visual and dimensional examination. A random sample of life preservers shall be selected in accordance with table III from each inspection lot of material offered for examination of visual and dimensional characteristics. Lot acceptance shall be based on the sampling inspection requirements in accordance with MIL-STD-105 as shown in table III. These requirements result in an acceptable quality level (AQL) of approximately 0.65 percent defective.

TABLE III. Sampling for visual and dimensional examination.

Number of life preservers in examination lot	Number of life preservers in sample	Acceptance number (defectives)	Rejection number (defectives)
110 or under	15	0	1
111 to 300	25	0	1
301 to 500	35	0	1
501 to 800	50	1	2
801 to 1300	75	1	2
1301 to 3000	110	2	3

4.4.4 Sampling for quality conformance tests. A random sample of life preservers and body strap assemblies shall be selected from each inspection lot in accordance with table IV and shall be subjected to the examination and tests of 4.5, 4.6.2, and 4.6.3 to verify compliance with this specification. Any sample life preserver or body strap assembly which does not meet the requirements for these characteristics shall cause rejection of the lot represented by the sample.

TABLE IV. Sampling for lot acceptance tests.

Number of life preservers or body strap assemblies in lot	Number of body strap assemblies for breaking strength test	Number of life preservers for pad immersion test	Number of life preservers for pad seam and distribution of buoyant medium test
110 or under	7	5	3
111 to 500	10	7	5
501 to 1300	15	10	7
1301 to 3000	25	15	10

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4.5 Visual and dimensional examination. Sample life preservers complete with body strap assemblies selected in accordance with 4.4.3 shall be thoroughly examined to determine conformance with the requirements of this specification. Examination shall be conducted as specified in table V.

TABLE V. Classification of defects.

Categories	Defects
Critical	
1	Components damaged, incorrect, missing, misfitting, or faulty, impairing the function of the preserver as life saving equipment.
Major	
101	Positioning of harness incorrect.
102	Stitching of cotton drill, webbing, and tapes non-conforming; not correct type stitch.
103	Slide fastener fly, slider protection patch, chafing patch, and safety tab (as applicable) not located as specified.
104	Dimensions not as specified on applicable drawings.
Minor	
201	Completed preserver not clean; evidence of dirt or oil spots.
202	Improper tensioning in stitching in parts other than harness.
203	Incorrect or illegible marking or both of preserver.

4.5.1 Noncompliance. If a sample fails to pass group B inspection, the manufacturer shall notify the qualifying activity and the cognizant inspection activity of such failure and take corrective action on the materials or processes, or both, as warranted, and on all units of product which can be corrected and which were manufactured with essentially the same materials and processes, and which are considered subject to the same failure. Acceptance and shipment of the product shall be discontinued until corrective action, acceptable to the qualifying activity has been taken. After the corrective action has been taken, group B inspection shall be repeated on additional sample units (all tests and examinations, or the test which the original sample failed, at the option of the qualifying activity). Group A inspections may be reinstituted; however, final acceptance and shipment shall be withheld until the group B inspection has shown that the corrective action was successful. In the event of failure after reinspection, information concerning the failure shall be furnished to the cognizant inspection activity and the qualifying activity.

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4.6 Tests.

4.6.1 General. All tests not herein described shall be in accordance with the methods specified in FED-STD-191; method 5660 shall be used for all light fastness tests.

4.6.2 Breaking strength of body strap assembly.

4.6.2.1 Testing machine method. A section of the strap assembly with the D-ring engaged in the snap hook and including the sliding buckle shall be taken for the test. The specimen shall be of sufficient length so that the distance between the jaws of the testing machine shall be approximately 10 inches after the specimen has been clamped for testing. The rate of separation of the jaws of the testing machine shall be approximately 12 inches per minute. The strap assembly shall not break nor show signs of deformation when subjected to a load of 360 pounds.

4.6.2.2 Alternate dead weight method. A portion of the front body strap assembly, with the D-ring engaged in the snap hook, and including the sliding buckle, shall be taken for the test. One end of this assembly shall be fastened to a weight of 360 pounds and other end shall be attached to a suitable lifting device having a maximum rate of lift not exceeding 12 inches per minute. After carefully taking up the slack, the weight shall be lifted free of its point of rest and allowed to swing clear for at least 1 minute. The strap assembly shall not break nor show signs of deformation during this test. All tests conducted by this method shall be made at prevailing atmospheric conditions.

4.6.3 Buoyancy. The completed front and back pads shall be individually tested to show compliance with 3.5.1. In this test, the pad shall be placed in a cage of adequate size and of sufficient weight to submerge the pad. This assembly shall be suspended from a direct reading scale, in fresh water, at room temperature, with the top of the cage 2 inches beneath the surface of the water. The scale reading shall be taken as soon as practicable and the buoyancy calculated as the apparent weight of the cage and pad subtracted from the previously determined underwater weight of the assembly without the pad.

4.6.4 Collar and tie tapes. In addition to the light fastness test (see 4.6.1), the collar ties and tunnel tapes shall be subjected to the following tests specified in FED-STD-191 to determine compliance with 3.2.4.2 and 3.2.4.3:

Test	Method
Weight	5041
Breaking strength	5100
Fastness to:	
Salt water	5632
Crocking	5651

4.7 Inspection of packaging. Sample packages and packs, and the inspection of the preservation-packaging, packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with the requirements of section 5 and the documents specified therein.

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5. PACKAGING

(The packaging requirements specified herein apply only for direct Government acquisition. For the extent of applicability of the packaging requirements of referenced documents listed in section 2, see 6.4.)

5.1 Life preservers shall be packaged by level A or C, packed by level A, B, or C, and marked in accordance with MIL-P-3454 as specified (see 6.2.1).

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Life preservers made in accordance with this specification are intended for use on surface ships.

6.2 Ordering data.

6.2.1 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type required (see 1.2).
(c) When first article is required (see 3.1).
(d) Color of preserver required (see 3.2.1).
(e) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing required (see 5.1).

6.2.2 Data requirements. When this specification is used in an acquisition and data are required to be delivered, the data requirements identified below shall be developed as specified by an approved Data Item Description (DD Form 1664) and delivered in accordance with the approved Contract Data Requirements List (CDRL), incorporated into the contract. When the provisions of DoD FAR Supplement, Part 27, Sub-Part 27.410-6 (DD Form 1423) are invoked and the DD Form 1423 is not used, the data specified below shall be delivered by the contractor in accordance with the contract or purchase order requirements. Deliverable data required by this specification are cited in the following paragraph.

Paragraph no.	Data requirement title	Applicable DID no.	Option
4.1.2	Report, first article test	DI-T-2072	----

(Data item descriptions related to this specification, and identified in section 6 will be approved and listed as such in DoD 5010.12-L., Vol. I, AMSDL. Copies of data item descriptions required by the contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the Naval Publications and Forms Center or as directed by the contracting officer.)

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6.2.2.1 The data requirements of 6.2.2 and any task in sections 3, 4, or 5 of this specification required to be performed to meet a data requirement may be waived by the contracting/acquisition activity upon certification by the offeror that identical data were submitted by the offeror and accepted by the Government under a previous contract for identical item acquired to this specification. This does not apply to specific data which may be required for each contract regardless of whether an identical item has been supplied previously (for example, test reports).

6.3 First article. When a first article inspection is required, the items should be a first article sample. The first article should consist of the samples specified in 4.3. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for examinations, approval of first article test results and disposition of first articles. Invitations for bids should provide that the Government reserves the right to waive the requirement for samples for first article inspection to those bidders offering a product which has been previously acquired or tested by the Government, and that bidders offering such products, who wish to rely on such production or test, must furnish evidence with the bid that prior Government approval is presently appropriate for the pending contract.

6.4 Sub-contracted material and parts. The packaging requirements of referenced documents listed in section 2 do not apply when material and parts are acquired by the contractor for incorporation into the equipment and lose their separate identity when the equipment is shipped.

6.5 Subject term (key word) listing.

Collar
Life preserver
Outer jacket
Slide fastener
Vest

6.6 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:
Army - ME
Navy - SH
Air Force - 99

Preparing activity:
Navy - SH
(Project 4220-0318)

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NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-L-18045F	Life Preservers, Vest, Inherently Bouyant

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*:

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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